

Λύγκευς ὁ Σάμιος

Athenian Dining in the Comedies of Lynceus of Samos

eul_aid: iyi

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἀττική [Attic \(com, frg\)](#)

Domain: Κωμῳδία [Comedy](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Lynceus of Samos was a comic poet active in the late 4th and early 3rd centuries BCE, a contemporary of Menander. He was the brother of the historian and tyrant Duris of Samos and a pupil of the philosopher Theophrastus at the Lyceum, placing him within early Hellenistic intellectual circles in Athens.

His comic output survives only in fragments, with two known titles: **Centaur** and **Aphrodisia**. Lynceus also authored prose works, including a critical treatise **On Menander**, a collection of **Apophthegms**, and a gastronomic work titled **The Gastronomy**, which discussed culinary practices. He is also known to have written letters, including one to Ptolemy II Philadelphus.

Lynceus represents a bridge between New Comedy, Peripatetic philosophy, and Hellenistic prose. His gastronomic writing offers valuable insight into contemporary social history and material culture, while his treatise on Menander establishes him as an early critic of the foremost New Comedy playwright.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀθηναίων Δείπνων · [Fragments on Athenian Dining](#) · 19 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀθηναίων Δείπνων · [Fragments on Athenian Dining](#) · 18 passages